

meesho

SEASON 3

DICE CHALLENGE

FINDING NEW
WAYS FOR
MEESHO TO EARN

**BUSINESS
TRACK**

Introduction to Meesho

Meesho is a value-first marketplace focused on Tier-2, Tier-3, and smaller towns, characterised by a large catalog and low prices. A defining feature of the platform is its zero-commission model: unlike most marketplaces, Meesho does not take a share of a seller's sales. This keeps costs low for small sellers and prices low for buyers, and is central to Meesho's identity.

Because it does not charge commission, Meesho generates revenue through other services, including:

- **Advertising** — sellers pay to have their products shown more prominently.
- **Logistics** — fees for delivering products to buyers and handling returns.
- **Seller tools** — insights and data services that help sellers sell more effectively.
- **Assurance programs** — protection for sellers against costs such as returns.
- **Financial services** — loans and payment services for buyers and sellers.

These represent Meesho's existing revenue levers. The focus of this case is to look beyond them.

Objective

"Design a new way for Meesho to generate ~1% of NMV in new annual revenue — without compromising Meesho's promise of affordability for buyers and zero commission for sellers."

The requirement is to propose something genuinely new, rather than a larger or slightly modified version of an existing lever. A strong idea creates a new form of value for sellers, buyers, or other businesses Meesho could serve — something they would willingly pay for because it helps them — rather than charging more for the same offering.

You are not restricted to Meesho's current users. You can speak with Meesho sellers, or with any other SME businesses that sell online, or with other stakeholders you believe Meesho could serve (kirana stores, B2B SMEs like wholesalers, manufacturers etc.).

Expected Benefits

- A new growth engine: A fresh revenue stream that scales alongside the business, beyond today's levers.
- Greater value for sellers or buyers: Effective ideas address a real problem, making people genuinely willing to pay.
- A stronger marketplace: New services should improve the platform overall — stronger sellers, more satisfied buyers, and greater loyalty.

Challenges

1. **Avoiding repetition of existing levers:** Suggesting "more ads" or "higher delivery fees" is straightforward. The more valuable challenge is identifying a genuinely new source of value.
2. **Willingness to pay:** An idea only succeeds if sellers or buyers perceive enough value to pay for it. Demonstrating this, rather than assuming it, is the central test.
3. **Serving small players:** Most Meesho sellers are small businesses. An idea suited only to large brands overlooks the majority of the marketplace.
4. **Protecting affordability:** Meesho's core appeal lies in low prices and zero commission. Ideas should ensure that Meesho continues to compound its affordability flywheel.

Required Output

3-Slider Submission Round

- **The Opportunity:** Identify a real, unmet need among Meesho's sellers or buyers — or among other SMEs and stakeholders Meesho could serve — and explain why addressing it could become a new revenue stream.
- **The Idea:** Explain clearly how Meesho would earn from it — what is offered, and how it is paid for.
- **Why It Fits:** In one slide, argue why the idea is genuinely new and consistent with Meesho's affordability and zero-commission promise.

6–10 Slider Detailed Deck Submission

- **The Problem:** The unmet need identified, grounded in conversations with real sellers, buyers, or other businesses.
- **The Solution & How It Earns:** What Meesho would offer, and how it would generate revenue (for example, a subscription, a small fee, or a pay-per-use charge).
- **Proof People Will Pay:** Evidence from conversations — whether they would pay, how much, and what concerns them.
- **Rough Sizing:** A simple, assumption-backed estimate of potential revenue, and whether roughly 1% of NMV is realistic.
- **Roadmap:** A 30-60-90 day plan to test the idea through a small pilot.
- **Risks & Guardrails:** What could go wrong, and how buyer prices, small sellers, and trust would be protected.

Evaluation Criteria

3-Slider Submission Round:

1. Extent of Research – Methods, Sources, Coverage
2. Quality of Insights
3. User-First Approach
4. Problem-First Mindset

Detailed deck submission:

1. Quality of Research – Methods, Sources, Coverage
2. Depth of Analysis
3. Innovativeness of Recommendations
4. 10x and Long-term Thinking
5. Feasibility of Implementation
6. Presentation Skills

Guidelines / How to score better on this case

1. Speak to 7–10 people to identify a real unmet need — and, importantly, to test whether they would actually pay for the idea. These can be Meesho sellers and/or users, any other SME businesses that sell online, or other stakeholders you believe Meesho could serve (for example, kirana stores for a B2B e-commerce opportunity, or SMEs for an IndiaMART-style offering). Float surveys to strengthen the research.
2. Conduct secondary research on how other platforms, in India or globally, generate revenue in creative ways.
3. Support the idea with simple sizing and clearly stated assumptions — show the working.

Deliverables

Design a new revenue idea for Meesho that addresses:

- What real, unmet need of a seller, buyer, or other business does it solve?
- How exactly would Meesho earn from it — and why is it genuinely new?
- Would people actually pay for it, and how do you know?
- How would you test it over 30-60-90 days, and how large could it become?

Good luck! We look forward to seeing how you tackle this challenge and come up with innovative ideas for Meesho's growth and success.